

INSIDE THE INDUSTRY

CHICAGO LISTING AGENTS: YOU HAVE THE BEST CARD AT THE TABLE.

Chicago just ranked number one in home value growth for the fourth month running.

D.J. Paris
Keeping It Real Podcast

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**CHICAGO HOME
VALUES ARE UP 6.9
PERCENT THIS
YEAR. NO OTHER
MAJOR METRO IS
CLOSE.**

Inventory is tightening at the same time prices are climbing.

THE NUMBER THAT SHOULD OPEN EVERY SEPTEMBER LISTING CONVERSATION.

The S&P Cotality Case-Shiller Home Price Index, released August 25, 2026 using June sales data, put Chicago's year-over-year home price gain at 6.9 percent, the strongest of any major metro in the 20-city index for the fourth consecutive month, ahead of New York at 4.8 percent and Cleveland at 4.1 percent. At the same time, active listings ran 6 percent below a year ago and new listings fell 7.5 percent, per Option Premier's September 2 market update. A seller weighing whether to list this month is deciding against a market with rising prices and shrinking supply, and most of them have not heard the number.

BRING THIS TO THE NEXT LISTING APPOINTMENT:

- 1 Don't open with a generic "the market is strong" line.**

A seller has heard that from every agent who ever called them.
- 2 Do lead with the exact ranking.**

"Chicago just posted the strongest home price growth of any major metro in the country, four months in a row."
- 3 Do pair it with the supply number.**

New listings are down 7.5 percent from a year ago, so a seller who lists now is competing against less inventory, not more.

THE TAKEAWAY

**THE NUMBER ONE
METRO IN THE
COUNTRY IS THE
ONE YOU ALREADY
WORK IN.**

Use it in the next listing conversation, not the next newsletter.